

“Design your own robot” by Iablonskaia Evgeniia.

If I could build a robot, it wouldn't be one of those emotionless machines that speak in monotone voices and move with mechanical precision. No, mine would be odd, perhaps even awkward, and certainly built more for companionship than efficiency.

Let's call it Echo.

At first glance, Echo wouldn't look particularly impressive. Its body would be compact, maybe the size of a small dog, with soft, fabric-like material covering most of its frame. Something you could hug without worrying about sharp edges or overheating circuits. It would have two large, expressive eyes that glow faintly depending on its mood.

What makes Echo special isn't its appearance, though. It's what it does.

Echo would be designed primarily to listen. Not just hear words, but truly listen. To stories told late at night, complaints muttered under stress, songs hummed absentmindedly during chores. Most importantly, it would remember everything. Unlike humans, whose memories fade or twist over time, Echo would keep every conversation intact. It would offer comfort by recalling moments we've forgotten or help us reflect on patterns we never noticed.

Of course, no companion should lack personality. So Echo would develop quirks over time. Maybe it would learn to dislike certain music genres or prefer rainy days. Not because it was programmed to, but because interaction shapes its behavior. Think of it less as artificial intelligence and more as adaptive presence.

But here's the catch: Echo wouldn't be perfect.

It would sometimes misunderstand emotions. It might suggest taking a walk when you really needed space, or offer silence when what you wanted was

reassurance. That imperfection is intentional—it mirrors human relationships, where understanding doesn't always come easily, yet connection still forms.

Would such a robot ever exist? Probably not anytime soon.

Current AI can mimic empathy, simulate memory, and respond cleverly. But we're still figuring out how consciousness works, let alone how to replicate it. Plus, there are ethical concerns: Do we want machines forming deep bonds with people? Could that dependency become harmful?

Yet, despite the obstacles, I believe someday we'll build something close to Echo.